

They help to relieve aching feet, mild swelling in the feet, ankles, and legs, as well as fluid retention. They may be particularly helpful if you have to be on your feet for long periods of time for work. Thankfully, an element of fashion has been introduced and many brands are sheer and pretty. There is a variety available: some are thigh- or knee-high (see image) and others cover the whole leg. You'll find lighter stockings for summer wear, when the hot weather can lead to more swelling. You can also buy maternity hose that provide support for your baby and uterus, taking the pressure off your back.

